GPSC CBRT · HOMOEOPATHIC PHYSICIAN · CORE

Topic 2: Homoeopathic Materia Medica

Complete notes with pictures, memory hooks, rapid revision and practice MCQs.

Topic 2: Homoeopathic Materia Medica

How to use this guide

- Materia Medica is one of the ten Core topics (the Core section carries 25 of the 60 CBRT marks), so expect about 2 to 3 questions.
- Most of them name a keynote and ask for the remedy, or name a remedy and ask its modality, source or relationship.
- The GPSC syllabus has four headings, and this guide follows them:

Syllabus heading	What it covers	Section
Nature, scope and drug relationships	Sources, construction, comparative MM, modalities, complementary, inimical and antidotal relationships	2.1
Plant remedies (41)	Aconite to Veratrum viride	2.2
Mineral, chemical and acid remedies (39)	Alumina to Zincum	2.3
Nosodes, sarcodes and special therapeutics	Bacillinum, Medorrhinum, Psorinum, Pyrogenium, Thuja, Glonoine; organ remedies	2.4

- Each remedy is set as one row: **source**, **keynote**, **modality** and one **exam hook**.
- Learn the keynote column first; it answers most questions.
- Standard books: Boericke, *Pocket Manual of Homoeopathic Materia Medica*; Allen, *Keynotes*; Kent, *Lectures on Materia Medica*; Clarke, *Dictionary of Practical Materia Medica*; Phatak, *Materia Medica of Homoeopathic Medicines*.

Memory hook: picture each remedy as a person with **one sentence**: Aconite is "sudden fear in cold dry wind", Bryonia is "lie still, worse any motion". If you can say the sentence, you have the remedy.

2.1 Nature, scope and drug relationships

Homoeopathic Materia Medica is the record of the pathogenetic effects of drugs, found by proving on healthy people, together with toxicological data and clinical confirmations. Hahnemann's *Materia Medica Pura* (1811 to 1821, six volumes) is the first pure MM; *Fragmenta de viribus* (1805) recorded 27 drugs.

Sources of the Materia Medica

1. **Drug provings** on healthy people: the primary source (Organon §§105 to 145).
2. **Toxicology**: accidental and intentional poisonings, which show the gross effects.
3. **Clinical observations**: symptoms cured though never proved, marked as clinical.
4. **Animal experiments**, for tissue changes only.

Construction: how MMs are arranged

Type	Plan	Examples
Pure / schematic	Proving symptoms in Hahnemann's head-to-foot schema	Hahnemann's *MM Pura*; T. F. Allen's *Encyclopedia* (10 vols); Hering's *Guiding Symptoms* (10 vols)
Clinical	Arranged by disease or clinical use	Boericke (with repertory); Clarke's *Dictionary*
Keynote	Only the leading features	H. C. Allen's *Keynotes*; Nash's *Leaders*
Comparative	Remedies compared side by side	Farrington's *Comparative MM*; Gibson-Miller *Relationship of Remedies*
Lecture / drug picture	The remedy as a person	Kent's *Lectures*; Tyler's *Drug Pictures*
Physiological / group	By family or chemical group	Farrington's *Clinical MM*; Phatak

Modalities

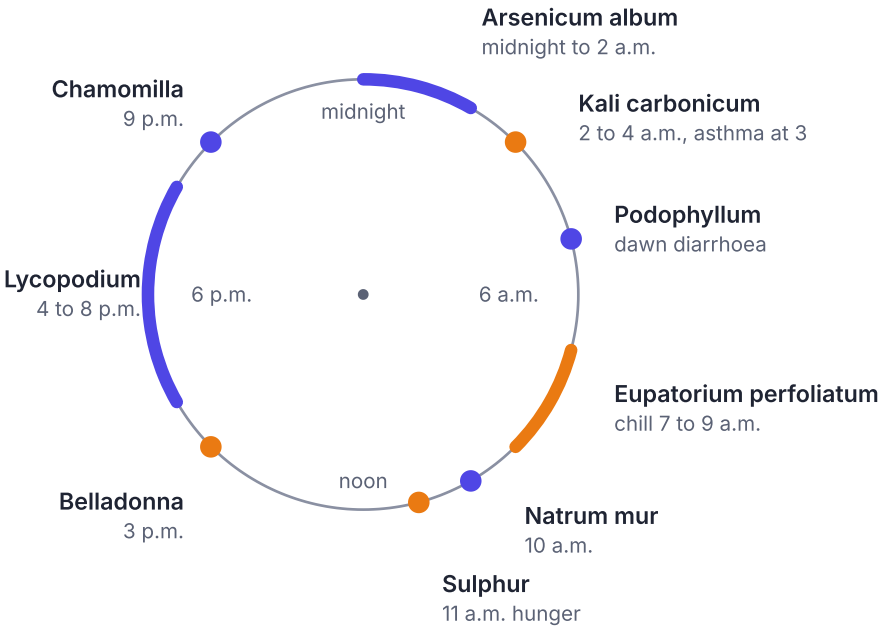
A **modality** is a condition that makes a symptom better (amel., >) or worse (agg., <): time, temperature, weather, position, motion, touch, eating, emotions. Modalities turn a common symptom into a characteristic one, and Boenninghausen generalised them to the whole patient.

Classic modality	Remedy
Worse from slightest motion, better lying on painful side	Bryonia
Better from continued motion, worse first motion, worse wet weather	Rhus tox
Worse 4 to 8 p.m.	Lycopodium
Worse 1 to 2 a.m. (after midnight)	Arsenicum album

Classic modality	Remedy
Worse 3 a.m.	Kali carb
Worse after sleep	Lachesis
Worse in warm room, better open air	Pulsatilla
Worse cold dry wind	Aconite, Hepar sulph, Causticum
Better from hard pressure, bending double	Colocynth
Worse touch, jar, light, noise	Belladonna

The aggravation clock: when each remedy is worst

24 hours, midnight at the top; arcs mark a span of hours, dots a single hour



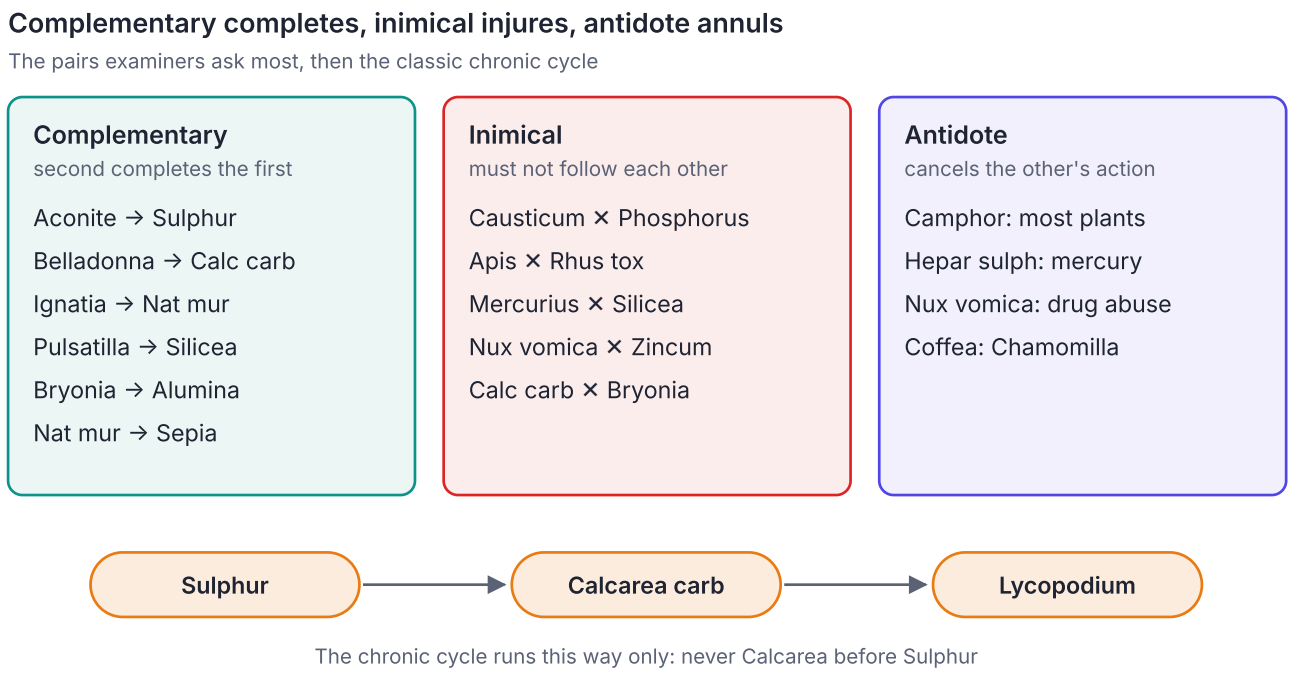
aggravation clock · 9 remedies around 24 hours

Walk round the clock from midnight: Arsenicum, Kali carb, Podophyllum, Eupatorium, Nat mur, Sulphur, Belladonna, Lycopodium, Chamomilla.

Drug relationships

Relationship	Meaning	Pairs to remember
Complementary	Completes the action of the first remedy	Aconite → Sulphur; Belladonna → Calc carb; Nat mur → Sepia; Pulsatilla → Silicea; Bryonia → Alumina; Sulphur → Calc carb → Lycopodium (the trio)

Relationship	Meaning	Pairs to remember
Inimical	Should not follow each other	Causticum ↔ Phosphorus; Apis ↔ Rhus tox; Mercurius ↔ Silicea; Nux vomica ↔ Zincum; Calc carb not after Bryonia or Nitric acid
Antidote	Removes the effects of another remedy	Camphor antidotes most plant remedies; Nux vomica antidotes drug abuse; Hepar sulph antidotes mercury; Coffea antidotes Chamomilla
Follows well	A good next remedy	Arnica → Rhus tox; Belladonna → Mercurius; Ipecac → Arsenicum
Acute and chronic	Acute remedy and its chronic complement	Bryonia / Alumina; Belladonna / Calc carb; Ignatia / Nat mur; Rhus tox / Calc fluor



drug relationships · complementary, inimical, antidote

Green pairs work together, red pairs clash, blue ones cancel: recall the colour first, then the pair.

The common teaching cycle **Sulphur → Calcarea carb → Lycopodium** (and back to Sulphur) is asked often; the order is not reversed: Calcarea is not given before Sulphur.

Memory hook: C-I-A — **C**omplementary completes, **I**nimical injures, **A**ntidote annuls. For inimicals chant "**Cause Phos**-trouble, **Apis Rhus**-hes in, **Merc Sil**-ences": Causticum–Phosphorus, Apis–Rhus tox, Mercurius–Silicea.

Differentiating allied remedies

Comparative Materia Medica (Farrington, Gibson-Miller) sets look-alike remedies side by side. The exam gives one telling feature and expects the right twin.

Look-alikes	First remedy	Second remedy
Aconite vs Belladonna (sudden, violent fevers)	**Aconite**: after exposure to cold dry wind; fear of death, anxious restlessness; great thirst	**Belladonna**: heat, redness, throbbing; dilated pupils; delirium; worse touch, jar, light, noise
Bryonia vs Rhus tox (pains and motion)	**Bryonia**: worse from the slightest motion; better rest, pressure, lying on the painful side; thirst for large quantities	**Rhus tox**: worse on first motion, better from continued motion; restless; worse cold damp and rest
Ignatia vs Natrum mur (grief)	**Ignatia**: recent, acute grief; sighing; changeable, contradictory symptoms; lump in the throat	**Natrum mur**: old, silent grief; consolation aggravates; craves salt; headache from sunrise to sunset
Pulsatilla vs Sepia (women's remedies)	**Pulsatilla**: mild, weepy, wants consolation; thirstless; worse warm room, better open air; changeable symptoms	**Sepia**: indifferent to loved ones; bearing-down sensation; better from vigorous exercise
Arsenicum vs Phosphorus (anxious, burning)	**Arsenicum album**: chilly, restless anxiety; burning pains better by heat; thirst for small sips; worse after midnight	**Phosphorus**: craves cold water, vomited once warm in the stomach; bright red bleeding; fears being alone and thunder
Nux vomica vs Lycopodium (digestive)	**Nux vomica**: irritable, chilly, sedentary; ineffectual urging for stool; worse in the morning	**Lycopodium**: full after a few mouthfuls, bloating; right-sided; worse 4 to 8 p.m.
Apis vs Cantharis (burning, urinary)	**Apis**: oedema; stinging pains; thirstless; better from cold	**Cantharis**: violent burning and cutting; constant urging, urine drop by drop; burns and scalds

Memory hook: pick the twin by the **modality or the mind**, never by the common symptom: both twins share the fever, the pain or the grief; only one has the wind, the motion, the consolation or the time.

2.2 Plant remedies

Forty-one plant remedies are named in the syllabus. Each row gives the common name and family, the keynote, the modality and the hook examiners use. Read across a row as one sentence.

Aconite to Eupatorium

Remedy (source)	Keynote	Worse / better	Exam hook
Aconitum napellus (monkshood, Ranunculaceae)	Sudden violent onset after cold dry wind; great fear of death, predicts the hour; restless anxiety	< evening, night, warm room; > open air	First stage of inflammation, before exudation
Aethusa cynapium (fool's parsley, Umbelliferae)	Infant cannot digest milk: vomits curds forcibly soon after nursing, then drowsy	< 3 to 4 a.m., summer	Milk intolerance; "inability to think"
Aloe socotrina (aloes, Liliaceae)	Insecure rectum: stool escapes with flatus; jelly-like lumpy stools; drives out of bed in the morning	< early morning, heat; > cold	Piles like a bunch of grapes, > cold water
Arnica montana (leopard's bane, Compositae)	Bruised sore feeling, bed feels too hard; says he is well when very ill; fears being touched	< touch, motion; > lying, head low	First remedy for injury and shock
Baptisia tinctoria (wild indigo, Leguminosae)	Typhoid state: feels body scattered, tries to gather the pieces; falls asleep mid-answer; offensive discharges	< humid heat	Painless throat: swallows only liquids
Belladonna (deadly nightshade, Solanaceae)	Sudden heat, redness, throbbing; dilated pupils; violent delirium, wants to bite or escape	< touch, jar, light, noise, 3 p.m.; > semi-erect	Hot, red, dry, sudden
Berberis vulgaris (barberry, Berberidaceae)	Radiating stitching pains from the kidney region; bubbling sensation; urine changes often	< motion, jar, standing	Renal and biliary colic, pains radiate
Bryonia alba (white bryony, Cucurbitaceae)	Stitching pains; dry membranes; thirst for large drinks at long intervals; irritable, wants to go home	< slightest motion; > pressure, lying on painful side, rest	Dry hard stool as if burnt
Cannabis indica (hashish, Cannabinaceae)	Exaggerated time and space: minutes seem ages; uncontrollable laughter	< morning, coffee	Time distortion
Capsicum annuum (cayenne, Solanaceae)	Homesickness with red cheeks; burning smarting pains; fat, lazy, lax fibre	< cold air, draught; > heat, eating	Mastoiditis; homesickness

Remedy (source)	Keynote	Worse / better	Exam hook
Chamomilla (German chamomile, Compositae)	Cannot bear pain; one cheek red, one pale; child wants to be carried; green stools like chopped eggs	< anger, heat, 9 p.m., night; > being carried	Teething; ailments from anger
Cinchona officinalis (China) (Peruvian bark, Rubiaceae)	Weakness from loss of vital fluids; periodicity; bloating not relieved by belching	< slightest touch, draught, alternate days; > hard pressure	First drug Hahnemann proved (1790)
Cocculus indicus (Indian cockle, Menispermaceae)	Sick from riding in a vehicle; ailments from loss of sleep and nursing the sick; hollow feeling	< vehicle motion, loss of sleep	Travel sickness
Coffea cruda (unroasted coffee, Rubiaceae)	Over-sensitive; sleepless from rush of ideas or joy; toothache > ice-cold water	< excess joy, noise, open air	Sleeplessness from good news
Colchicum autumnale (meadow saffron, Liliaceae)	Gout; nausea and faintness from the smell of cooking food; autumnal dysentery	< motion, evening, smell of food	Nausea from the smell of food
Colocynthis (bitter cucumber, Cucurbitaceae)	Violent cutting colic; ailments from anger with indignation	< anger; > bending double, hard pressure	Colic better bending double
Digitalis purpurea (foxglove, Scrophulariaceae)	Very slow, weak, irregular pulse; feels the heart would stop if he moves; faint sinking at stomach	< sitting erect, motion	Slow pulse; cardiac jaundice
Dulcamara (bittersweet, Solanaceae)	Complaints from damp cold, getting wet, hot days and cold nights; flat smooth warts	< cold damp, night; > warmth	Ailments from wet weather
Eupatorium perfoliatum (boneset, Compositae)	Bone-breaking pains in fever; chill 7 to 9 a.m. with thirst; vomiting of bile	< 7 to 9 a.m., periodically	Influenza, dengue: "break-bone"

Gelsemium to Veratrum viride

Remedy (source)	Keynote	Worse / better	Exam hook
Gelsemium sempervirens (yellow jasmine, Loganiaceae)	Dull, dizzy, drowsy, drooping; trembling; thirstless fever; anticipatory anxiety, diarrhoea from bad news	< emotion, anticipation, damp; > profuse urination	Heavy eyelids (ptosis); exam fright
Hyoscyamus niger (henbane, Solanaceae)	Jealousy, obscenity, wants to uncover; foolish laughter; dry cough < lying, > sitting	< lying, night, touch	Jealous, shameless delirium
Ignatia amara (St Ignatius bean, Loganiaceae)	Grief and disappointment; sighing; lump in throat; contradictory symptoms	< grief, consolation, coffee, tobacco; > eating, change of position	Remedy of contradictions
Ipecacuanha (ipecac root, Rubiaceae)	Constant nausea not relieved by vomiting; clean tongue; bright red bleeding; rattling cough	< vomiting, lying, periodically	Nausea with a clean tongue
Ledum palustre (marsh tea, Ericaceae)	Punctured wounds and stings; the part is cold to touch yet > cold; gout ascends	< warmth of bed; > cold applications	Prevents tetanus; black eye
Lilium tigrinum (tiger lily, Liliaceae)	Bearing down as if pelvic organs would fall out; hurried; religious gloom alternating with sexual excitement	< consolation, warm room	Uterine prolapse with heart pain
Mezereum (spurge olive, Thymelaeaceae)	Eczema with thick crusts and pus beneath; intolerable itching; pain after herpes zoster	< cold air, night, warm bed, touch	Crusts with pus under them
Nux vomica (poison nut, Loganiaceae)	Irritable, fastidious, over-sensitive; sedentary life, stimulants; ineffectual urging for stool; chilly	< morning, mental strain, after eating, cold; > evening, rest, pressure	Ineffectual urging; "businessman"
Opium (poppy, Papaveraceae)	Painlessness, stupor, complaints from fright; constipation with no urge, round black balls; contracted pupils	< heat, during and after sleep	Lack of reaction

Remedy (source)	Keynote	Worse / better	Exam hook
Podophyllum peltatum (may apple, Berberidaceae)	Profuse gushing painless morning diarrhoea, then weakness; diarrhoea alternates with headache	< early morning, hot weather, teething	Gushing diarrhoea at dawn
Pulsatilla nigricans (wind flower, Ranunculaceae)	Mild, yielding, weeps easily, wants consolation; changeable symptoms; thirstless; bland yellow-green discharges	< warm room, evening, rich food; > open air, consolation	Weepy, thirstless, wants open air
Rhododendron chrysanthum (snow rose, Ericaceae)	Rheumatic pains worse before a thunderstorm; orchitis, testis drawn up	< before a storm, wind; > after the storm breaks	Dread of thunder
Rhus toxicodendron (poison ivy, Anacardiaceae)	Restless; stiffness < first motion, > continued motion; red triangular tip of tongue; vesicles	< cold damp, rest, overlifting; > warmth, continued motion	The "rusty gate"
Rumex crispus (yellow dock, Polygonaceae)	Dry tickling cough from cold air, covers the mouth; morning diarrhoea	< inhaling cold air, uncovering, pressure on throat-pit	Cough < cold air
Ruta graveolens (rue, Rutaceae)	Bruised bones, periosteum and tendons; eyestrain from fine work; rectal prolapse	< lying, cold, wet, using the eyes	Tendons and eyestrain
Sabina (savine, Cupressaceae)	Bright red uterine bleeding with clots; pain from sacrum to pubis; threatened abortion in the 3rd month	< heat, least motion; > cool fresh air	Pain sacrum to pubis
Sanguinaria canadensis (blood root, Papaveraceae)	Right-sided periodic headache from occiput to over the right eye; burning palms and soles; flushes	< sun, right side; > sleep, vomiting	Right-sided sun headache
Spigelia anthelmia (pinkroot, Loganiaceae)	Left-sided neuralgia of face and eye rising and setting with the sun; violent palpitation; fear of pins	< touch, motion, noise; > lying on right side	Left-sided neuralgia; worms
Staphisagria (stavesacre, Ranunculaceae)	Suppressed anger and indignation; effects of insult; clean cuts and surgical wounds; styes	< anger, touch	Incised wounds; "honeymoon" cystitis

Remedy (source)	Keynote	Worse / better	Exam hook
Stramonium (thorn apple, Solanaceae)	Violent delirium; fear of the dark, wants light and company; stammering; fear of water	< dark, alone, shining objects	Fear of the dark
Veratrum album (white hellebore, Melanthiaceae)	Collapse with cold sweat on the forehead; profuse vomiting and purging; thirst for cold water	< least motion, drinking	Cold sweat on the forehead (cholera)
Veratrum viride (American hellebore, Melanthiaceae)	Violent congestion, high blood pressure; red streak down the middle of the tongue; sunstroke	< rising; > lying	Red stripe on the tongue

Families worth knowing

- **Solanaceae:** Belladonna, Hyoscyamus, Stramonium (the three delirium remedies), Capsicum, Dulcamara.
- **Loganiaceae:** Nux vomica, Ignatia, Gelsemium, Spigelia.
- **Ranunculaceae:** Aconite, Pulsatilla, Staphisagria.
- **Rubiaceae:** Cinchona, Ipecac, Coffea.
- **Compositae:** Arnica, Chamomilla, Eupatorium.

Memory hook: the delirium trio by temperature of mind: **Bell burns** (hot, violent, red), **Hyos hides nothing** (jealous, shameless, uncovers), **Stram screams for light** (terror of the dark). And for motion: **Bryonia freezes, Rhus tox keeps walking.**

2.3 Mineral, chemical and acid remedies

The syllabus puts 39 remedies under this heading. A few are not minerals (Anacardium is a nut, Apis a bee, Bovista a puff-ball, Cantharis a beetle, Spongia a sponge), and the source column says so, since source questions are common.

Alumina to Fluoric acid

Remedy (source)	Keynote	Worse / better	Exam hook
Alumina (aluminium oxide)	Extreme dryness; constipation with no urge, even a soft stool needs straining; craves chalk and charcoal; time passes too slowly	< morning, potatoes, alternate days; > evening, open air	Chronic of Bryonia
Ammonium carbonicum (ammonium carbonate)	Fat, sedentary women; nosebleed on washing the face in the morning; dyspnoea, weak heart	< 3 a.m., cold wet; > lying on the stomach	Nosebleed on washing the face
Anacardium orientale (marking nut, a plant)	Two wills, contradiction; feeling of a plug in rectum and elsewhere; memory loss; cursing	< hot water applications; > eating	Better while eating
Antimonium crudum (black sulphide of antimony)	Thick milky-white tongue; cross, cannot bear to be touched or looked at; horny callosities; overeating	< sun's heat, cold bathing; > rest, open air	White-coated tongue
Antimonium tartaricum (tartar emetic)	Coarse rattling of mucus with little expectoration; drowsy, weak; nausea	< lying, warmth, damp cold; > sitting up, expectorating	Rattling chest, young and old
Apis mellifica (honey bee)	Oedema; stinging, burning pains; thirstless; jealous and busy; scanty urine	< heat, touch, after sleep; > cold, open air	Stinging, thirstless, puffy
Argentum nitricum (silver nitrate)	Anticipatory anxiety with diarrhoea; hurried, impulsive; craves sweets that disagree; flatulence; fear of heights	< warmth, sweets, emotion; > cold, fresh air	Splinter pains; fear of heights
Arsenicum album (arsenious oxide)	Anxiety, restlessness and prostration out of proportion; burning > heat; thirst for small sips; fastidious; fear of death	< midnight to 2 a.m., cold, cold drinks; > heat, head raised	Burning better by heat
Aurum metallicum (gold)	Profound depression, suicidal, feels worthless; bone pains at night; high blood pressure	< night, cold, winter	Suicidal depression
Baryta carbonica (barium carbonate)	Dwarfish in mind and body; slow, shy, hides behind furniture; big tonsils; children and the old	< thinking of complaints, cold; > walking in open air	Slow, shy child

Remedy (source)	Keynote	Worse / better	Exam hook
Borax (sodium borate)	Fear of downward motion; aphthae in the mouth; infant cries when laid down	< downward motion, sudden noise; > pressure	Fear of downward motion
Bovista (puff-ball fungus)	Puffy, awkward, drops things; blunt instruments leave deep marks; menses only at night	< full moon, heat	Deep marks from blunt edges
Calcarea carbonica (middle layer of oyster shell)	Fat, fair, flabby, chilly; sweat on the head; craves eggs and chalk; slow; open fontanelles	< cold wet, exertion, milk; > dry weather	Sweaty head, craves eggs
Calcarea phosphorica (calcium phosphate)	Delayed dentition and late-closing fontanelles; tall, thin; craves smoked meat; growing pains	< cold damp, weather change; > summer, lying	Craves bacon
Cantharis (Spanish fly, a beetle)	Burning, raw, cutting pains; constant urging, urine drop by drop with burning; burns and scalds	< touch, urinating, cold water; > warmth, rubbing	Burning cystitis; burns
Carbo vegetabilis (vegetable charcoal)	Collapse, wants to be fanned; cold breath; flatulence > belching; venous stasis	< evening, fat food, warm damp; > fanning, belching	The "corpse reviver"
Causticum (Hahnemann's tinctura acris sine kali)	Gradual paralysis (vocal cords, bladder, right face); burning rawness; sympathy for others; urine escapes on coughing	< dry cold wind, clear weather; > damp wet weather	Better in wet weather
Ferrum metallicum (iron)	Anaemia with false plethora, face flushes easily; vomits food after eating	< rest, midnight, eggs; > walking slowly	Pseudo-plethora
Ferrum phosphoricum (iron phosphate)	First stage of inflammation, less violent than Aconite; flushing; nosebleed	< night, 4 to 6 a.m., right side; > cold	Tissue salt for early fever
Fluoricum acidum (hydrofluoric acid)	Varicose veins, bone caries; a hot patient; more able to exert than before	< warmth; > cold, walking	Hot patient, bone decay

Graphites to Zincum

Remedy (source)	Keynote	Worse / better	Exam hook
Graphites (black lead, plumbago)	Fat, chilly, constipated; eczema with honey-like sticky discharge, cracks behind the ears; timid; music makes her weep	< warmth (skin), night, menses; > dark, wrapping up	Honey-like discharge
Hepar sulphuris calcareum (Hahnemann's calcium sulphide)	Over-sensitive to pain, cold and touch; splinter pains; tends to suppurate; very chilly, irritable	< cold dry air, uncovering, touch; > warmth, damp weather	Suppuration: low potency ripens, high aborts
Iodium (iodine)	Thin despite a ravenous appetite, > eating; restless, hot; hard enlarged glands, goitre	< warmth, rest, fasting; > eating, cold air	Eats well, yet wastes
Kali carbonicum (potassium carbonate)	Stitching pains; weak back; bag-like swelling of the upper lids; asthma at 3 a.m. > bending forward; rigid, dutiful	< 2 to 4 a.m., cold, lying on left side; > warm weather, sitting forward	Puffy upper lids
Magnesia carbonica (magnesium carbonate)	Sour-smelling child; green frothy stools like frog-pond scum; night neuralgia, must walk about	< rest, warmth of bed, temperature change; > walking about	The "orphan's remedy"
Mercurius solubilis (Hahnemann's soluble mercury)	Profuse offensive sweat that does not relieve; salivation; flabby tongue with tooth marks; metallic taste	< night, sweating, warmth of bed	The "human thermometer"
Natrum carbonicum (sodium carbonate)	Weak digestion and weak ankles; cannot bear sun, heat or milk; averse to company	< summer heat, sun, mental strain, milk; > movement	Weak ankles; sun headache
Natrum muriaticum (common salt)	Ailments from grief, consolation aggravates; craves salt; thin neck; hammering headache sunrise to sunset; map tongue	< 10 a.m., sun, consolation, seashore; > open air, cold bathing	Consolation aggravates
Natrum sulphuricum (Glauber's salt)	Hydrogenoid constitution, worse damp; effects of head injury; diarrhoea after rising	< damp weather, lying on left side; > dry weather	Head injury; damp asthma

Remedy (source)	Keynote	Worse / better	Exam hook
Nitricum acidum (nitric acid)	Splinter-like pains; fissures where skin meets mucous membrane; urine smells like a horse's; warts bleed easily; vindictive	< evening, night, cold, touch; > riding in a carriage	Splinter pains, strong urine
Petroleum (crude rock oil)	Deep bleeding cracks of skin in winter, healed in summer; motion sickness; diarrhoea only by day	< winter, riding, thunderstorm; > warm dry air	Winter eczema
Phosphorus (phosphorus)	Tall, slender, sympathetic; fears being alone and thunder; craves cold water, vomited once warm in the stomach; bright red bleeding	< lying on left side, twilight; > eating, sleep, cold food	Vomits water once warm
Platinum metallicum (platinum)	Pride, looks down on others; things look smaller than they are; numbness; hypersensitive genitals	< evening, touch; > walking in open air	Objects look small
Silicea (pure flint)	Lacks grit, yielding yet obstinate; chilly; offensive foot sweat; expels foreign bodies; stool slips back	< cold, uncovering, new moon; > warmth, wrapping the head	"Bashful" stool
Spongia tosta (roasted sponge)	Dry, sawing, barking croup cough like a saw through a pine board; goitre; heart symptoms	< before midnight, ascending, cold wind; > warm food and drink	Croup
Stannum metallicum (tin)	Great weakness of the chest, too weak to talk; pains come and go gradually; sweet green sputum	< talking, 10 a.m.; > hard pressure, coughing up	Pains rise and fall slowly
Sulphur (sublimated sulphur)	Untidy philosopher; burning soles and vertex; itching < warmth of bed; craves sweets and fats; hungry at 11 a.m.; red orifices	< bathing, warmth of bed, standing, 11 a.m.; > dry warm weather	King of antipsorics
Sulphuricum acidum (sulphuric acid)	Weakness with inner trembling; always in a hurry; dark bleeding; hot flushes; alcoholism	< cold, open air; > warmth, hot drinks	Weakness and trembling
Zincum metallicum (zinc)	Brain fag; fidgety feet, cannot keep them still; suppressed eruptions	< wine, touch, 5 to 7 p.m.; > discharges, eating	Fidgety feet

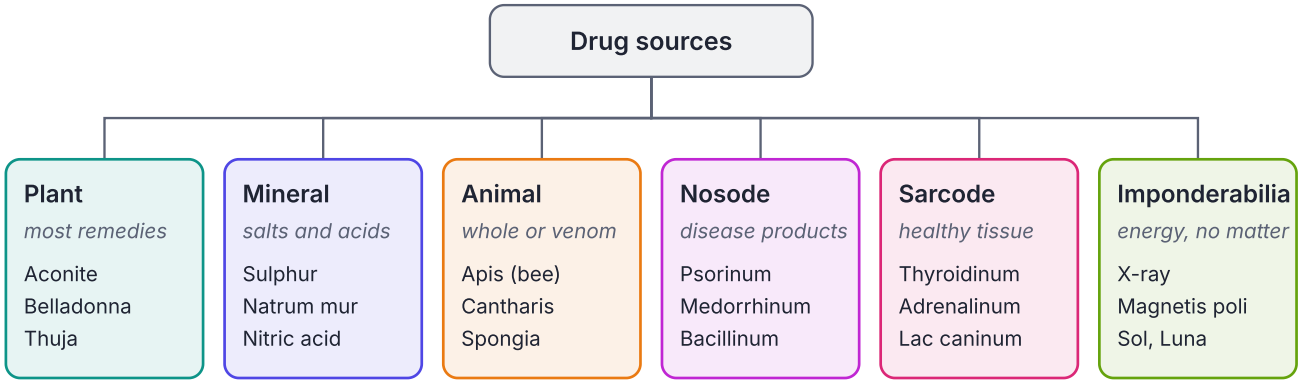
Memory hook: the **Natrum family** splits by weather: **Nat mur** hates the **sun**, **Nat carb** hates the **sun and milk**, **Nat sulph** hates the **damp**. And the **Calc pair** by food: **Calc carb** wants **eggs**, **Calc phos** wants **bacon**.

2.4 Nosodes, sarcodes and special therapeutics

Definitions

- **Nosodes** are prepared from diseased tissue or the products of disease (discharges, cultures, morbid tissue). Hering introduced the idea; Burnett and Swan widened its use.
- **Sarcodes** are prepared from healthy animal tissues and secretions: Thyroidinum, Adrenalinum, Pituitrinum, Insulinum, Lac caninum.
- **Imponderabilia** are energies with no material substance: X-ray, Magnetis poli, Sol, Luna, Electricitas.
- A nosode is often used as an **intercurrent remedy** when the well-chosen remedy stops acting or a miasm blocks progress.

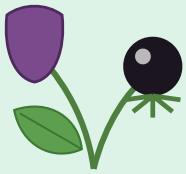
Six sources of homoeopathic drugs: name the source, then the remedy



drug sources · 6 kinds with examples

Where the remedies come from

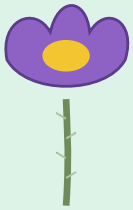
Source, family and one keynote to hang it on



Belladonna

deadly nightshade · Solanaceae

Sudden heat, redness, throbbing; dilated pupils



Pulsatilla

wind flower · Ranunculaceae

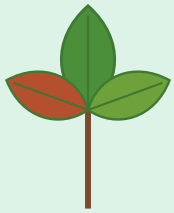
Mild, weepy, thirstless; better in open air



Arnica

leopard's bane · Compositae

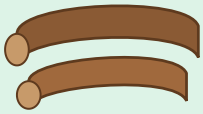
Bruised soreness; says he is well when very ill



Rhus tox

poison ivy · Anacardiaceae

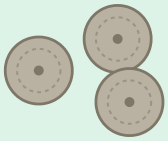
Stiff; worse first motion, better continued motion



Cinchona (China)

Peruvian bark · Rubiaceae

Weakness from loss of fluids; first drug proved



Nux vomica

poison nut (seeds) · Loganiaceae

Irritable, chilly; urging without result



Apis

honey bee

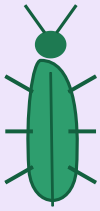
Oedema, stinging pains, thirstless



Lachesis

snake venom

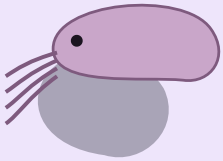
Worse after sleep



Cantharis

Spanish fly, a beetle

Burning cystitis; burns and scalds



Sepia

cuttlefish ink

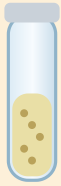
Complements Nat mur



Spongia

roasted sponge

Dry, sawing croup cough like a saw through pine



Nosodes

disease products

Psorinum, Medorrhinum, Pyrogenium, Bacillinum

Trap: Apis, Cantharis and Spongia are ANIMAL remedies even when listed with the minerals (purple tiles).

Remedy sources · plants, animals and nosodes, each with one keynote

Source questions often hide a trap: Apis, Cantharis and Spongia are animal remedies even when listed with minerals.

The six named in the syllabus

Remedy (source)	Keynote	Worse / better	Exam hook
Bacillinum (Burnett; tuberculous lung tissue)	Recurrent colds, tubercular tendency; ringworm; catarrh with thick sputum	< night, cold	Burnett's nosode; ringworm
Medorrhinum (gonorrhoeal discharge)	Sycotic; always in a hurry yet time passes slowly; bites nails; sleeps in the knee-chest position	< sunrise to sunset, heat; > seashore, lying on the abdomen	Better at the seashore
Psorinum (scabies vesicle)	Very chilly, wants warm clothes even in summer; dirty, offensive discharges; hopeless despair; hungry at night	< cold, open air, coffee; > heat, lying with arms spread apart	Wears a fur coat in summer
Pyrogenium (decomposed lean beef)	Septic states; pulse out of proportion to temperature; bed feels too hard; restless	< cold; > heat, motion	Pulse and temperature mismatch
Thuja occidentalis (arbor vitae, a plant)	Anti-sycotic: warts, fig-warts, polypi; fixed idea that the body is brittle or made of glass; sweat on uncovered parts	< cold damp, 3 a.m. and 3 p.m., vaccination; > drawing up a limb	Ill effects of vaccination
Glonoine (nitroglycerine)	Sudden violent bursting, throbbing headache; sunstroke; cannot bear heat on the head	< sun, heat, jar; > cold, open air	Sunstroke

Clinical organ therapeutics

Organ remedies (Rademacher's idea, developed by Burnett as **organopathy**) act on one organ and are often used in low potency or mother tincture alongside the constitutional remedy.

Organ	Organ remedies
Heart	Crataegus (heart tonic), Cactus grandiflorus (constriction as if by an iron band), Digitalis
Liver	Chelidonium (pain under the right scapula), Carduus marianus, Chionanthus
Spleen	Ceanothus americanus
Kidney	Berberis vulgaris, Solidago virgaurea
Bladder	Cantharis, Equisetum

Organ	Organ remedies
Prostate	Sabal serrulata
Uterus	Caulophyllum, Sabina
Thyroid	Thyroidinum, Iodium, Spongia
Bones and teeth	Calcarea phos, Symphytum (fracture)

Memory hook: **N**osode = **N**asty (disease product); **S**arcode = **S**ound (healthy tissue). Then the six in a sentence: "**Medo** loves the sea, **Psor** wears a fur coat, **Pyro**'s pulse lies, **Thuja** hates the needle, **Glonoine** hates the sun, **Bacillinum** keeps catching cold."

Rapid revision

Cue	Remedy or fact
Sudden onset after cold dry wind, fear of death	Aconite
Worse slightest motion, thirst for large quantities	Bryonia
Better continued motion, worse first motion	Rhus tox
Weepy, thirstless, worse warm room	Pulsatilla
Consolation aggravates, craves salt	Natrum mur
Burning better by heat, worse after midnight	Arsenicum album
Collapse, wants to be fanned	Carbo veg
Cold sweat on the forehead, cholera	Veratrum album
Nausea with a clean tongue	Ipecac
Colic better bending double	Colocynth
Punctured wound, part cold yet better cold	Ledum
Gushing painless morning diarrhoea	Podophyllum
Milk vomited in curds by infants	Aethusa
Fear of downward motion	Borax

Cue	Remedy or fact
Vomits water once it warms in the stomach	Phosphorus
Splinter pains, horse-like urine	Nitric acid
Croup like a saw through a board	Spongia
Better at the seashore	Medorrhinum
Pulse out of proportion to temperature	Pyrogenium
Sunstroke, bursting headache	Glonoine
First drug proved by Hahnemann	Cinchona (1790)
King of antipsorics	Sulphur
Inimical pairs	Causticum–Phosphorus, Apis–Rhus tox, Mercurius–Silicea
Nosode / sarcode	Diseased product / healthy tissue

One-glance recall card

Topic 2 recall card: the 15 keynotes asked most

Cover the small lines, name the remedy from the big cue, then check

Cold dry wind sudden onset, fear of death: Aconite	**Lies still** worse slightest motion, big thirst: Bryonia	**Rusty gate** worse first motion, better continued motion: Rhus tox
Weepy, thirstless worse warm room, better open air: Pulsatilla	**Consolation agg.** grief, craves salt, sun headache: Nat mur	**Burning > heat** restless, sips, worse after midnight: Arsenicum
Clean tongue nausea not relieved by vomiting: Ipecac	**Bending double** colic better pressure and bending: Colocynth	**Cold yet > cold** punctured wounds, stings: Ledum
Fan me collapse, cold breath, wants air: Carbo veg	**Warm water vomit** vomits water once warm in stomach: Phosphorus	**Seashore** better at the sea, knee-chest sleep: Medorrhinum
Pulse mismatch pulse out of step with temperature: Pyrogenium	**1790** first drug Hahnemann proved: Cinchona	**Inimical** Causticum-Phosphorus, Apis-Rhus, Merc-Silicea

Topic 2 recall card · 15 tiles

For the last ten minutes before the exam: cover the small lines of each tile and name the remedy from the big cue.

Practice MCQs

1. A remedy whose complaints come on suddenly after exposure to cold dry wind, with fear of death, is: (a) Belladonna (b) Aconite (c) Bryonia (d) Gelsemium
2. Worse from the slightest motion and better lying on the painful side is typical of: (a) Rhus tox (b) Bryonia (c) Pulsatilla (d) Arnica
3. A thirstless, weepy patient who is worse in a warm room and better in open air needs: (a) Pulsatilla (b) Natrum mur (c) Sepia (d) Ignatia
4. Constant nausea not relieved by vomiting, with a clean tongue, suggests: (a) Nux vomica (b) Antimonium crudum (c) Ipecacuanha (d) Arsenicum album

5. Colic better by bending double and hard pressure is a keynote of: (a) Chamomilla (b) Colocynthis (c) Belladonna (d) Dioscorea
6. The first drug Hahnemann proved on himself was: (a) Aconite (b) Belladonna (c) Cinchona (d) Sulphur
7. Punctured wounds that are cold to touch yet better by cold applications call for: (a) Hypericum (b) Arnica (c) Ledum (d) Calendula
8. An infant who vomits milk in curds soon after nursing and then falls asleep needs: (a) Aethusa (b) Magnesia carb (c) Calcarea carb (d) Chamomilla
9. Fear of downward motion is a keynote of: (a) Gelsemium (b) Borax (c) Argentum nitricum (d) Calcarea carb
10. Water is vomited as soon as it becomes warm in the stomach in: (a) Arsenicum album (b) Bismuth (c) Phosphorus (d) Veratrum album
11. Splinter-like pains with urine smelling like a horse's suggest: (a) Hepar sulph (b) Nitric acid (c) Argentum nitricum (d) Benzoic acid
12. A croupy cough sounding like a saw driven through a pine board needs: (a) Hepar sulph (b) Aconite (c) Spongia tosta (d) Drosera
13. Consolation aggravates, craving for salt and a hammering headache from sunrise to sunset point to: (a) Ignatia (b) Natrum mur (c) Sepia (d) Staphisagria
14. Which pair is inimical? (a) Sulphur and Calcarea carb (b) Causticum and Phosphorus (c) Belladonna and Calcarea carb (d) Nat mur and Sepia
15. A remedy prepared from the products of disease is called a: (a) sarcode (b) nosode (c) imponderabilia (d) tissue salt
16. Medorrhinum patients are characteristically better: (a) in the mountains (b) at the seashore (c) in a warm room (d) after sleep
17. A pulse out of proportion to the temperature in septic fever suggests: (a) Baptisia (b) Pyrogenium (c) Arsenicum album (d) Lachesis
18. Bursting headache from exposure to the sun (sunstroke) is a keynote of: (a) Natrum carb (b) Glonoine (c) Belladonna (d) Gelsemium
19. Collapse with a cold body and a desire to be fanned calls for: (a) Camphor (b) Veratrum album (c) Carbo vegetabilis (d) Arsenicum album
20. Ill effects of vaccination are classically treated with: (a) Thuja (b) Silicea (c) Sulphur (d) Medorrhinum

Answer key

Q	Answer	Why
1	b	Sudden onset, cold dry wind, fear of death

Q	Answer	Why
2	b	Bryonia wants to lie still; pressure relieves
3	a	Weepy, thirstless, warm room aggravates
4	c	Ipecac: nausea with a clean tongue
5	b	Colocynth: better bending double
6	c	Cinchona bark, 1790
7	c	Ledum: cold yet better cold
8	a	Aethusa: milk intolerance in infants
9	b	Borax: fear of downward motion
10	c	Phosphorus vomits water once warm
11	b	Nitric acid: splinter pains, strong urine
12	c	Spongia: sawing croup
13	b	Nat mur: grief, salt, sun headache
14	b	Causticum and Phosphorus must not follow each other
15	b	Nosode = product of disease
16	b	Medorrhinum is better at the seashore
17	b	Pyrogenium: pulse–temperature mismatch
18	b	Glonoine: sunstroke
19	c	Carbo veg: the "corpse reviver"
20	a	Thuja: vaccination and sycosis